

DVD Parameters

Parameters	DVD	HD DVD	BD
Capacity per layer (GB)	4.7	15	25
Max number of layers	2	2	2
Max number of sides	2	2	1
Disc thickness (mm)	0.6 + 0.6	0.6 + 0.6	1.1 + 0.1
Laser wavelength (nm)	650	405	405
Numerical aperture	0.60	0.65	0.85
Cartridge	No	No	No
Tilt control needed	No	Yes	NA
Hard coating needed	No	No	Yes
Complexity to read regular DVD	—	OK	More complex

There is also talk of having dual layer versions for the masses available a little later, that is, after the launch of both these products. But that is still subject to speculation since both products are yet to go mainstream and the first—either HD-DVD or Blu-ray—is slated to be launched later this year or only early next year.

But with the roses come the thorns. With all the hullabaloo of Blu-ray and HD-DVD making the rounds, there is a hidden cost of improvising your existing equipment too. So while your current DVD player will probably play HD-DVD discs, you will need to buy a new player for watching movies on Blu-ray discs. Backward compatibility does not seem to be a major factor since these players are assumed to be able to play older DVD discs without any issues.

Regarding watching movies on your PC, which is more on the lines of making your PC your entertainment hub, it could be an issue with both disc formats. Why? Let's get to know the new face of copy protection.